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Prediction mode signaling in video coding

Abstract

A method of encoding video data includes obtaining a parameter set associated with a non-skip mode coded block; signaling a first syntax element in a bitstream; signaling a second syntax element in the bitstream; and signaling a third syntax element in the bitstream. The method further includes encoding video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using palette mode when the first syntax element has a first value and the third syntax element has the first value; encoding the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using intra prediction mode when the first syntax element has the first value and the third syntax element has a second value; encoding the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using inter prediction mode when the first syntax element has the second value; and transmitting the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block via the bitstream.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a continuation application of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/591,456, filed on Feb. 2, 2022, which is a continuation of PCT Application No. PCT/US2020/049653, entitled “PREDICTION MODE SIGNALING IN VIDEO CODING” filed on Sep. 8, 2020, which claims priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/897,292, entitled “PREDICTION MODE SIGNALING IN VIDEO CODING” filed on Sep. 7, 2019. The contents of these applications are incorporated herein by reference in their entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present application generally relates to video data encoding and decoding, and in particular, to method and system for prediction modes signaling in video coding.

BACKGROUND

(2) Digital video is supported by a variety of electronic devices, such as digital televisions, laptop or desktop computers, tablet computers, digital cameras, digital recording devices, digital media players, video gaming consoles, smart phones, video teleconferencing devices, video streaming devices, etc. The electronic devices transmit, receive, encode, decode, and/or store digital video data by implementing video compression/decompression standards as defined by MPEG-4, ITU-T H.263, ITU-T H.264/MPEG-4, Part 10, Advanced Video Coding (AVC), High Efficiency Video Coding (HEVC), and Versatile Video Coding (VVC) standard. Video compression typically includes performing spatial (intra frame) prediction and/or temporal (inter frame) prediction to reduce or remove redundancy inherent in the video data. For block-based video coding, a video frame is partitioned into one or more slices, each slice having multiple video blocks, which may also be referred to as coding tree units (CTUs). Each CTU may contain one coding unit (CU) or recursively split into smaller CUs until the predefined minimum CU size is reached. Each CU (also named leaf CU) contains one or multiple transform units (TUs) and each CU also contains one or multiple prediction units (PUs). Each CU can be coded in either intra, inter or IBC modes. Video blocks in an intra coded (I) slice of a video frame are encoded using spatial prediction with respect to reference samples in neighbor blocks within the same video frame. Video blocks in an inter coded (P or B) slice of a video frame may use spatial prediction with respect to reference samples in neighbor blocks within the same video frame or temporal prediction with respect to reference samples in other previous and/or future reference video frames.

(3) Spatial or temporal prediction based on a reference block that has been previously encoded, e.g., a neighbor block, results in a predictive block for a current video block to be coded. The process of finding the reference block may be accomplished by block matching algorithm. Residual data representing pixel differences between the current block to be coded and the predictive block is referred to as a residual block or prediction errors. An inter-coded block is encoded according to

a motion vector that points to a reference block in a reference frame forming the predictive block, and the residual block. The process of determining the motion vector is typically referred to as motion estimation. An intra coded block is encoded according to an intra prediction mode and the residual block. For further compression, the residual block is transformed from the pixel domain to a transform domain, e.g., frequency domain, resulting in residual transform coefficients, which may then be quantized. The quantized transform coefficients, initially arranged in a two-dimensional array, may be scanned to produce a one-dimensional vector of transform coefficients, and then entropy encoded into a video bitstream to achieve even more compression.

(4) The encoded video bitstream is then saved in a computer-readable storage medium (e.g., flash memory) to be accessed by another electronic device with digital video capability or directly transmitted to the electronic device wired or wirelessly. The electronic device then performs video decompression (which is an opposite process to the video compression described above) by, e.g., parsing the encoded video bitstream to obtain syntax elements from the bitstream and reconstructing the digital video data to its original format from the encoded video bitstream based at least in part on the syntax elements obtained from the bitstream, and renders the reconstructed digital video data on a display of the electronic device.

(5) With digital video quality going from high definition, to 4K×2K or even 8K×4K, the amount of video data to be encoded/decoded grows exponentially. It is a constant challenge in terms of how the video data can be encoded/decoded more efficiently while maintaining the image quality of the decoded video data.

SUMMARY

(6) The present application describes implementations related to video data encoding and decoding and, more particularly, to system and method for prediction modes signaling in video coding.

(7) According to a first aspect of the present application, a method of decoding video data is performed at a computing device having one or more processors and memory storing a plurality of programs to be executed by the one or more processors. The method comprises: receiving, from bitstream, video data corresponding to a non-skip mode coded block; determining a parameter set associated with the non-skip mode coded block; if the parameter set satisfies a first condition, retrieving a first syntax element from the bitstream; if the parameter set satisfies a second condition, retrieving a second syntax element from the bitstream; if the parameter set satisfies a third condition, retrieving a third syntax element from the bitstream; decoding the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using palette mode when the first syntax element and the third syntax element have the first value; decoding the video data using intra prediction mode when the first syntax element has the first value and the third syntax element has a second value; and decoding the video data using inter prediction mode when the first syntax element has the second value.

(8) According to a second aspect of the present application, a computing device includes one or more processors, memory and a plurality of programs stored in the memory. The programs, when executed by the one or more processors, cause the computing device to perform operations as described above.

(9) According to a third aspect of the present application, a non-transitory computer readable storage medium stores a plurality of programs for execution by a computing device having one or more processors. The programs, when executed by the one or more processors, cause the computing device to perform operations as described above.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) The accompanying drawings, which are included to provide a further understanding of the

implementations and are incorporated herein and constitute a part of the specification, illustrate the described implementations and together with the description serve to explain the underlying principles. Like reference numerals refer to corresponding parts.

(2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating an exemplary video encoding and decoding system in accordance with some implementations of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating an exemplary video encoder in accordance with some implementations of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram illustrating an exemplary video decoder in accordance with some implementations of the present disclosure.

(5) FIGS. 4A-4E are block diagrams illustrating how a frame is recursively quad-tree partitioned into multiple video blocks of different sizes in accordance with some implementations of the present disclosure.

(6) FIG. 5 is a block diagram illustrating different prediction modes of a coding unit in accordance with some implementations of the present disclosure.

(7) FIG. 6 is a flowchart illustrating an exemplary process by which a video coder implements the techniques of signaling prediction mode in accordance with some implementations of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) Reference will now be made in detail to specific implementations, examples of which are illustrated in the accompanying drawings. In the following detailed description, numerous non-limiting specific details are set forth in order to assist in understanding the subject matter presented herein. But it will be apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art that various alternatives may be used without departing from the scope of claims and the subject matter may be practiced without these specific details. For example, it will be apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art that the subject matter presented herein can be implemented on many types of electronic devices with digital video capabilities.

(9) FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating an exemplary system **10** for encoding and decoding video blocks in parallel in accordance with some implementations of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 1, system **10** includes a source device **12** that generates and encodes video data to be decoded at a later time by a destination device **14**. Source device **12** and destination device **14** may comprise any of a wide variety of electronic devices, including desktop or laptop computers, tablet computers, smart phones, set-top boxes, digital televisions, cameras, display devices, digital media players, video gaming consoles, video streaming device, or the like. In some implementations, source device **12** and destination device **14** are equipped with wireless communication capabilities.

(10) In some implementations, destination device **14** may receive the encoded video data to be decoded via a link **16**. Link **16** may comprise any type of communication medium or device capable of moving the encoded video data from source device **12** to destination device **14**. In one example, link **16** may comprise a communication medium to enable source device **12** to transmit the encoded video data directly to destination device **14** in real-time. The encoded video data may be modulated according to a communication standard, such as a wireless communication protocol, and transmitted to destination device **14**. The communication medium may comprise any wireless or wired communication medium, such as a radio frequency (RF) spectrum or one or more physical transmission lines. The communication medium may form part of a packet-based network, such as a local area network, a wide-area network, or a global network such as the Internet. The communication medium may include routers, switches, base stations, or any other equipment that may be useful to facilitate communication from source device **12** to destination device **14**.

(11) In some other implementations, the encoded video data may be transmitted from output interface **22** to a storage device **32**. Subsequently, the encoded video data in storage device **32** may be accessed by destination device **14** via input interface **28**. Storage device **32** may include any of a variety of distributed or locally accessed data storage media such as a hard drive, Blu-ray discs,

DVDs, CD-ROMs, flash memory, volatile or non-volatile memory, or any other suitable digital storage media for storing encoded video data. In a further example, storage device **32** may correspond to a file server or another intermediate storage device that may hold the encoded video data generated by source device **12**. Destination device **14** may access the stored video data from storage device **32** via streaming or downloading. The file server may be any type of computer capable of storing encoded video data and transmitting the encoded video data to destination device **14**. Exemplary file servers include a web server (e.g., for a website), an FTP server, network attached storage (NAS) devices, or a local disk drive. Destination device **14** may access the encoded video data through any standard data connection, including a wireless channel (e.g., a Wi-Fi connection), a wired connection (e.g., DSL, cable modem, etc.), or a combination of both that is suitable for accessing encoded video data stored on a file server. The transmission of encoded video data from storage device **32** may be a streaming transmission, a download transmission, or a combination of both.

(12) As shown in FIG. **1**, source device **12** includes a video source **18**, a video encoder **20** and an output interface **22**. Video source **18** may include a source such as a video capture device, e.g., a video camera, a video archive containing previously captured video, a video feed interface to receive video from a video content provider, and/or a computer graphics system for generating computer graphics data as the source video, or a combination of such sources. As one example, if video source **18** is a video camera of a security surveillance system, source device **12** and destination device **14** may form camera phones or video phones. However, the implementations described in the present application may be applicable to video coding in general, and may be applied to wireless and/or wired applications.

(13) The captured, pre-captured, or computer-generated video may be encoded by video encoder **20**. The encoded video data may be transmitted directly to destination device **14** via output interface **22** of source device **12**. The encoded video data may also (or alternatively) be stored onto storage device **32** for later access by destination device **14** or other devices, for decoding and/or playback. Output interface **22** may further include a modem and/or a transmitter.

(14) Destination device **14** includes an input interface **28**, a video decoder **30**, and a display device **34**. Input interface **28** may include a receiver and/or a modem and receive the encoded video data over link **16**. The encoded video data communicated over link **16**, or provided on storage device **32**, may include a variety of syntax elements generated by video encoder **20** for use by video decoder **30** in decoding the video data. Such syntax elements may be included within the encoded video data transmitted on a communication medium, stored on a storage medium, or stored a file server.

(15) In some implementations, destination device **14** may include a display device **34**, which can be an integrated display device and an external display device that is configured to communicate with destination device **14**. Display device **34** displays the decoded video data to a user, and may comprise any of a variety of display devices such as a liquid crystal display (LCD), a plasma display, an organic light emitting diode (OLED) display, or another type of display device.

(16) Video encoder **20** and video decoder **30** may operate according to proprietary or industry standards, such as VVC, HEVC, MPEG-4, Part 10, Advanced Video Coding (AVC), or extensions of such standards. It should be understood that the present application is not limited to a specific video coding/decoding standard and may be applicable to other video coding/decoding standards. It is generally contemplated that video encoder **20** of source device **12** may be configured to encode video data according to any of these current or future standards. Similarly, it is also generally contemplated that video decoder **30** of destination device **14** may be configured to decode video data according to any of these current or future standards.

(17) Video encoder **20** and video decoder **30** each may be implemented as any of a variety of suitable encoder circuitry, such as one or more microprocessors, digital signal processors (DSPs), application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), discrete

logic, software, hardware, firmware or any combinations thereof. When implemented partially in software, an electronic device may store instructions for the software in a suitable, non-transitory computer-readable medium and execute the instructions in hardware using one or more processors to perform the video coding/decoding operations disclosed in the present disclosure. Each of video encoder **20** and video decoder **30** may be included in one or more encoders or decoders, either of which may be integrated as part of a combined encoder/decoder (CODEC) in a respective device.

(18) FIG. **2** is a block diagram illustrating an exemplary video encoder **20** in accordance with some implementations described in the present application. Video encoder **20** may perform intra and inter predictive coding of video blocks within video frames. Intra predictive coding relies on spatial prediction to reduce or remove spatial redundancy in video data within a given video frame or picture. Inter predictive coding relies on temporal prediction to reduce or remove temporal redundancy in video data within adjacent video frames or pictures of a video sequence.

(19) As shown in FIG. **2**, video encoder **20** includes video data memory **40**, prediction processing unit **41**, decoded picture buffer (DPB) **64**, summer **50**, transform processing unit **52**, quantization unit **54**, and entropy encoding unit **56**. Prediction processing unit **41** further includes motion estimation unit **42**, motion compensation unit **44**, partition unit **45**, intra prediction processing unit **46**, and intra block copy (BC) unit **48**. In some implementations, video encoder **20** also includes inverse quantization unit **58**, inverse transform processing unit **60**, and summer **62** for video block reconstruction. A deblocking filter (not shown) may be positioned between summer **62** and DPB **64** to filter block boundaries to remove blockiness artifacts from reconstructed video. An in loop filter (not shown) may also be used in addition to the deblocking filter to filter the output of summer **62**. Video encoder **20** may take the form of a fixed or programmable hardware unit or may be divided among one or more of the illustrated fixed or programmable hardware units.

(20) Video data memory **40** may store video data to be encoded by the components of video encoder **20**. The video data in video data memory **40** may be obtained, for example, from video source **18**. DPB **64** is a buffer that stores reference video data for use in encoding video data by video encoder **20** (e.g., in intra or inter predictive coding modes). Video data memory **40** and DPB **64** may be formed by any of a variety of memory devices. In various examples, video data memory **40** may be on-chip with other components of video encoder **20**, or off-chip relative to those components.

(21) As shown in FIG. **2**, after receiving video data, partition unit **45** within prediction processing unit **41** partitions the video data into video blocks. This partitioning may also include partitioning a video frame into slices, tiles, or other larger coding units (CUs) according to a predefined splitting structures such as quad-tree structure associated with the video data. The video frame may be divided into multiple video blocks (or sets of video blocks referred to as tiles). Prediction processing unit **41** may select one of a plurality of possible predictive coding modes, such as one of a plurality of intra predictive coding modes or one of a plurality of inter predictive coding modes, for the current video block based on error results (e.g., coding rate and the level of distortion). Prediction processing unit **41** may provide the resulting intra or inter prediction coded block to summer **50** to generate a residual block and to summer **62** to reconstruct the encoded block for use as part of a reference frame subsequently. Prediction processing unit **41** also provides syntax elements, such as motion vectors, intra-mode indicators, partition information, and other such syntax information, to entropy encoding unit **56**.

(22) In order to select an appropriate intra predictive coding mode for the current video block, intra prediction processing unit **46** within prediction processing unit **41** may perform intra predictive coding of the current video block relative to one or more neighboring blocks in the same frame as the current block to be coded to provide spatial prediction. Motion estimation unit **42** and motion compensation unit **44** within prediction processing unit **41** perform inter predictive coding of the current video block relative to one or more predictive blocks in one or more reference frames to provide temporal prediction. Video encoder **20** may perform multiple coding passes, e.g., to select

an appropriate coding mode for each block of video data.

(23) In some implementations, motion estimation unit **42** determines the inter prediction mode for a current video frame by generating a motion vector, which indicates the displacement of a prediction unit (PU) of a video block within the current video frame relative to a predictive block within a reference video frame, according to a predetermined pattern within a sequence of video frames. Motion estimation, performed by motion estimation unit **42**, is the process of generating motion vectors, which estimate motion for video blocks. A motion vector, for example, may indicate the displacement of a PU of a video block within a current video frame or picture relative to a predictive block within a reference frame (or other coded unit) relative to the current block being coded within the current frame (or other coded unit). The predetermined pattern may designate video frames in the sequence as P frames or B frames. Intra BC unit **48** may determine vectors, e.g., block vectors, for intra BC coding in a manner similar to the determination of motion vectors by motion estimation unit **42** for inter prediction, or may utilize motion estimation unit **42** to determine the block vector.

(24) A predictive block is a block of a reference frame that is deemed as closely matching the PU of the video block to be coded in terms of pixel difference, which may be determined by sum of absolute difference (SAD), sum of square difference (SSD), or other difference metrics. In some implementations, video encoder **20** may calculate values for sub-integer pixel positions of reference frames stored in DPB **64**. For example, video encoder **20** may interpolate values of one-quarter pixel positions, one-eighth pixel positions, or other fractional pixel positions of the reference frame. Therefore, motion estimation unit **42** may perform a motion search relative to the full pixel positions and fractional pixel positions and output a motion vector with fractional pixel precision.

(25) Motion estimation unit **42** calculates a motion vector for a PU of a video block in an inter prediction coded frame by comparing the position of the PU to the position of a predictive block of a reference frame selected from a first reference frame list (List 0) or a second reference frame list (List 1), each of which identifies one or more reference frames stored in DPB **64**. Motion estimation unit **42** sends the calculated motion vector to motion compensation unit **44** and then to entropy encoding unit **56**.

(26) Motion compensation, performed by motion compensation unit **44**, may involve fetching or generating the predictive block based on the motion vector determined by motion estimation unit **42**. Upon receiving the motion vector for the PU of the current video block, motion compensation unit **44** may locate a predictive block to which the motion vector points in one of the reference frame lists, retrieve the predictive block from DPB **64**, and forward the predictive block to summer **50**. Summer **50** then forms a residual video block of pixel difference values by subtracting pixel values of the predictive block provided by motion compensation unit **44** from the pixel values of the current video block being coded. The pixel difference values forming the residual video block may include luma or chroma difference components or both. Motion compensation unit **44** may also generate syntax elements associated with the video blocks of a video frame for use by video decoder **30** in decoding the video blocks of the video frame. The syntax elements may include, for example, syntax elements defining the motion vector used to identify the predictive block, any flags indicating the prediction mode, or any other syntax information described herein. Note that motion estimation unit **42** and motion compensation unit **44** may be highly integrated, but are illustrated separately for conceptual purposes.

(27) In some implementations, intra BC unit **48** may generate vectors and fetch predictive blocks in a manner similar to that described above in connection with motion estimation unit **42** and motion compensation unit **44**, but with the predictive blocks being in the same frame as the current block being coded and with the vectors being referred to as block vectors as opposed to motion vectors. In particular, intra BC unit **48** may determine an intra-prediction mode to use to encode a current block. In some examples, intra BC unit **48** may encode a current block using various intra-

prediction modes, e.g., during separate encoding passes, and test their performance through rate-distortion analysis. Next, intra BC unit **48** may select, among the various tested intra-prediction modes, an appropriate intra-prediction mode to use and generate an intra-mode indicator accordingly. For example, intra BC unit **48** may calculate rate-distortion values using a rate-distortion analysis for the various tested intra-prediction modes, and select the intra-prediction mode having the best rate-distortion characteristics among the tested modes as the appropriate intra-prediction mode to use. Rate-distortion analysis generally determines an amount of distortion (or error) between an encoded block and an original, unencoded block that was encoded to produce the encoded block, as well as a bitrate (i.e., a number of bits) used to produce the encoded block. Intra BC unit **48** may calculate ratios from the distortions and rates for the various encoded blocks to determine which intra-prediction mode exhibits the best rate-distortion value for the block.

(28) In other examples, intra BC unit **48** may use motion estimation unit **42** and motion compensation unit **44**, in whole or in part, to perform such functions for Intra BC prediction according to the implementations described herein. In either case, for Intra block copy, a predictive block may be a block that is deemed as closely matching the block to be coded, in terms of pixel difference, which may be determined by sum of absolute difference (SAD), sum of squared difference (SSD), or other difference metrics, and identification of the predictive block may include calculation of values for sub-integer pixel positions.

(29) Whether the predictive block is from the same frame according to intra prediction, or a different frame according to inter prediction, video encoder **20** may form a residual video block by subtracting pixel values of the predictive block from the pixel values of the current video block being coded, forming pixel difference values. The pixel difference values forming the residual video block may include both luma and chroma component differences.

(30) Intra prediction processing unit **46** may intra-predict a current video block, as an alternative to the inter-prediction performed by motion estimation unit **42** and motion compensation unit **44**, or the intra block copy prediction performed by intra BC unit **48**, as described above. In particular, intra prediction processing unit **46** may determine an intra prediction mode to use to encode a current block. To do so, intra prediction processing unit **46** may encode a current block using various intra prediction modes, e.g., during separate encoding passes, and intra prediction processing unit **46** (or a mode select unit, in some examples) may select an appropriate intra prediction mode to use from the tested intra prediction modes. Intra prediction processing unit **46** may provide information indicative of the selected intra-prediction mode for the block to entropy encoding unit **56**. Entropy encoding unit **56** may encode the information indicating the selected intra-prediction mode in the bitstream.

(31) After prediction processing unit **41** determines the predictive block for the current video block via either inter prediction or intra prediction, summer **50** forms a residual video block by subtracting the predictive block from the current video block. The residual video data in the residual block may be included in one or more transform units (TUs) and is provided to transform processing unit **52**. Transform processing unit **52** transforms the residual video data into residual transform coefficients using a transform, such as a discrete cosine transform (DCT) or a conceptually similar transform.

(32) Transform processing unit **52** may send the resulting transform coefficients to quantization unit **54**. Quantization unit **54** quantizes the transform coefficients to further reduce bit rate. The quantization process may also reduce the bit depth associated with some or all of the coefficients. The degree of quantization may be modified by adjusting a quantization parameter. In some examples, quantization unit **54** may then perform a scan of a matrix including the quantized transform coefficients. Alternatively, entropy encoding unit **56** may perform the scan.

(33) Following quantization, entropy encoding unit **56** entropy encodes the quantized transform coefficients into a video bitstream using, e.g., context adaptive variable length coding (CAVLC), context adaptive binary arithmetic coding (CABAC), syntax-based context-adaptive binary

arithmetic coding (SBAC), probability interval partitioning entropy (PIPE) coding or another entropy encoding methodology or technique. The encoded bitstream may then be transmitted to video decoder **30**, or archived in storage device **32** for later transmission to or retrieval by video decoder **30**. Entropy encoding unit **56** may also entropy encode the motion vectors and the other syntax elements for the current video frame being coded.

(34) Inverse quantization unit **58** and inverse transform processing unit **60** apply inverse quantization and inverse transformation, respectively, to reconstruct the residual video block in the pixel domain for generating a reference block for prediction of other video blocks. As noted above, motion compensation unit **44** may generate a motion compensated predictive block from one or more reference blocks of the frames stored in DPB **64**. Motion compensation unit **44** may also apply one or more interpolation filters to the predictive block to calculate sub-integer pixel values for use in motion estimation.

(35) Summer **62** adds the reconstructed residual block to the motion compensated predictive block produced by motion compensation unit **44** to produce a reference block for storage in DPB **64**. The reference block may then be used by intra BC unit **48**, motion estimation unit **42** and motion compensation unit **44** as a predictive block to inter predict another video block in a subsequent video frame.

(36) FIG. **3** is a block diagram illustrating an exemplary video decoder **30** in accordance with some implementations of the present application. Video decoder **30** includes video data memory **79**, entropy decoding unit **80**, prediction processing unit **81**, inverse quantization unit **86**, inverse transform processing unit **88**, summer **90**, and DPB **92**. Prediction processing unit **81** further includes motion compensation unit **82**, intra prediction unit **84**, and intra BC unit **85**. Video decoder **30** may perform a decoding process generally reciprocal to the encoding process described above with respect to video encoder **20** in connection with FIG. **2**. For example, motion compensation unit **82** may generate prediction data based on motion vectors received from entropy decoding unit **80**, while intra-prediction unit **84** may generate prediction data based on intra-prediction mode indicators received from entropy decoding unit **80**.

(37) In some examples, a unit of video decoder **30** may be tasked to perform the implementations of the present application. Also, in some examples, the implementations of the present disclosure may be divided among one or more of the units of video decoder **30**. For example, intra BC unit **85** may perform the implementations of the present application, alone, or in combination with other units of video decoder **30**, such as motion compensation unit **82**, intra prediction unit **84**, and entropy decoding unit **80**. In some examples, video decoder **30** may not include intra BC unit **85** and the functionality of intra BC unit **85** may be performed by other components of prediction processing unit **81**, such as motion compensation unit **82**.

(38) Video data memory **79** may store video data, such as an encoded video bitstream, to be decoded by the other components of video decoder **30**. The video data stored in video data memory **79** may be obtained, for example, from storage device **32**, from a local video source, such as a camera, via wired or wireless network communication of video data, or by accessing physical data storage media (e.g., a flash drive or hard disk). Video data memory **79** may include a coded picture buffer (CPB) that stores encoded video data from an encoded video bitstream. Decoded picture buffer (DPB) **92** of video decoder **30** stores reference video data for use in decoding video data by video decoder **30** (e.g., in intra or inter predictive coding modes). Video data memory **79** and DPB **92** may be formed by any of a variety of memory devices, such as dynamic random access memory (DRAM), including synchronous DRAM (SDRAM), magneto-resistive RAM (MRAM), resistive RAM (RRAM), or other types of memory devices. For illustrative purpose, video data memory **79** and DPB **92** are depicted as two distinct components of video decoder **30** in FIG. **3**. But it will be apparent to one skilled in the art that video data memory **79** and DPB **92** may be provided by the same memory device or separate memory devices. In some examples, video data memory **79** may be on-chip with other components of video decoder **30**, or off-chip relative to those components.

(39) During the decoding process, video decoder **30** receives an encoded video bitstream that represents video blocks of an encoded video frame and associated syntax elements. Video decoder **30** may receive the syntax elements at the video frame level and/or the video block level. Entropy decoding unit **80** of video decoder **30** entropy decodes the bitstream to generate quantized coefficients, motion vectors or intra-prediction mode indicators, and other syntax elements. Entropy decoding unit **80** then forwards the motion vectors and other syntax elements to prediction processing unit **81**.

(40) When the video frame is coded as an intra predictive coded (I) frame or for intra coded predictive blocks in other types of frames, intra-prediction unit **84** of prediction processing unit **81** may generate prediction data for a video block of the current video frame based on a signaled intra prediction mode and reference data from previously decoded blocks of the current frame.

(41) When the video frame is coded as an inter-predictive coded (i.e., B or P) frame, motion compensation unit **82** of prediction processing unit **81** produces one or more predictive blocks for a video block of the current video frame based on the motion vectors and other syntax elements received from entropy decoding unit **80**. Each of the predictive blocks may be produced from a reference frame within one of the reference frame lists. Video decoder **30** may construct the reference frame lists, List 0 and List 1, using default construction techniques based on reference frames stored in DPB **92**.

(42) In some examples, when the video block is coded according to the intra BC mode described herein, intra BC unit **85** of prediction processing unit **81** produces predictive blocks for the current video block based on block vectors and other syntax elements received from entropy decoding unit **80**. The predictive blocks may be within a reconstructed region of the same picture as the current video block defined by video encoder **20**.

(43) Motion compensation unit **82** and/or intra BC unit **85** determines prediction information for a video block of the current video frame by parsing the motion vectors and other syntax elements, and then uses the prediction information to produce the predictive blocks for the current video block being decoded. For example, motion compensation unit **82** uses some of the received syntax elements to determine a prediction mode (e.g., intra or inter prediction) used to code video blocks of the video frame, an inter prediction frame type (e.g., B or P), construction information for one or more of the reference frame lists for the frame, motion vectors for each inter predictive encoded video block of the frame, inter prediction status for each inter predictive coded video block of the frame, and other information to decode the video blocks in the current video frame.

(44) Similarly, intra BC unit **85** may use some of the received syntax elements, e.g., a flag, to determine that the current video block was predicted using the intra BC mode, construction information of which video blocks of the frame are within the reconstructed region and should be stored in DPB **92**, block vectors for each intra BC predicted video block of the frame, intra BC prediction status for each intra BC predicted video block of the frame, and other information to decode the video blocks in the current video frame.

(45) Motion compensation unit **82** may also perform interpolation using the interpolation filters as used by video encoder **20** during encoding of the video blocks to calculate interpolated values for sub-integer pixels of reference blocks. In this case, motion compensation unit **82** may determine the interpolation filters used by video encoder **20** from the received syntax elements and use the interpolation filters to produce predictive blocks.

(46) Inverse quantization unit **86** inverse quantizes the quantized transform coefficients provided in the bitstream and entropy decoded by entropy decoding unit **80** using the same quantization parameter calculated by video encoder **20** for each video block in the video frame to determine a degree of quantization. Inverse transform processing unit **88** applies an inverse transform, e.g., an inverse DCT, an inverse integer transform, or a conceptually similar inverse transform process, to the transform coefficients in order to reconstruct the residual blocks in the pixel domain.

(47) After motion compensation unit **82** or intra BC unit **85** generates the predictive block for the

current video block based on the vectors and other syntax elements, summer **90** reconstructs decoded video block for the current video block by summing the residual block from inverse transform processing unit **88** and a corresponding predictive block generated by motion compensation unit **82** and intra BC unit **85**. An in-loop filter (not pictured) may be positioned between summer **90** and DPB **92** to further process the decoded video block. The decoded video blocks in a given frame are then stored in DPB **92**, which stores reference frames used for subsequent motion compensation of next video blocks. DPB **92**, or a memory device separate from DPB **92**, may also store decoded video for later presentation on a display device, such as display device **34** of FIG. **1**.

(48) In a typical video coding process, a video sequence typically includes an ordered set of frames or pictures. Each frame may include three sample arrays, denoted SL, SCb, and SCr. SL is a two-dimensional array of luma samples. SCb is a two-dimensional array of Cb chroma samples. SCr is a two-dimensional array of Cr chroma samples. In other instances, a frame may be monochrome and therefore includes only one two-dimensional array of luma samples.

(49) As shown in FIG. **4A**, video encoder **20** (or more specifically partition unit **45**) generates an encoded representation of a frame by first partitioning the frame into a set of coding tree units (CTUs). A video frame may include an integer number of CTUs ordered consecutively in a raster scan order from left to right and from top to bottom. Each CTU is a largest logical coding unit and the width and height of the CTU are signaled by the video encoder **20** in a sequence parameter set, such that all the CTUs in a video sequence have the same size being one of 128×128 , 64×64 , 32×32 , and 16×16 . But it should be noted that the present application is not necessarily limited to a particular size. As shown in FIG. **4B**, each CTU may comprise one coding tree block (CTB) of luma samples, two corresponding coding tree blocks of chroma samples, and syntax elements used to code the samples of the coding tree blocks. The syntax elements describe properties of different types of units of a coded block of pixels and how the video sequence can be reconstructed at the video decoder **30**, including inter or intra prediction, intra prediction mode, motion vectors, and other parameters. In monochrome pictures or pictures having three separate color planes, a CTU may comprise a single coding tree block and syntax elements used to code the samples of the coding tree block. A coding tree block may be an $N \times N$ block of samples.

(50) To achieve a better performance, video encoder **20** may recursively perform tree partitioning such as binary-tree partitioning, ternary-tree partitioning, quad-tree partitioning or a combination of both on the coding tree blocks of the CTU and divide the CTU into smaller coding units (CUs). As depicted in FIG. **4C**, the 64×64 CTU **400** is first divided into four smaller CU, each having a block size of 32×32 . Among the four smaller CUs, CU **410** and CU **420** are each divided into four CUs of 16×16 by block size. The two 16×16 CUs **430** and **440** are each further divided into four CUs of 8×8 by block size. FIG. **4D** depicts a quad-tree data structure illustrating the end result of the partition process of the CTU **400** as depicted in FIG. **4C**, each leaf node of the quad-tree corresponding to one CU of a respective size ranging from 32×32 to 8×8 . Like the CTU depicted in FIG. **4B**, each CU may comprise a coding block (CB) of luma samples and two corresponding coding blocks of chroma samples of a frame of the same size, and syntax elements used to code the samples of the coding blocks. In monochrome pictures or pictures having three separate color planes, a CU may comprise a single coding block and syntax structures used to code the samples of the coding block. It should be noted that the quad-tree partitioning depicted in FIGS. **4C** and **4D** is only for illustrative purposes and one CTU can be split into CUs to adapt to varying local characteristics based on quad/ternary/binary-tree partitions. In the multi-type tree structure, one CTU is partitioned by a quad-tree structure and each quad-tree leaf CU can be further partitioned by a binary and ternary tree structure. As shown in FIG. **4E**, there are five partitioning types, i.e., quaternary partitioning, horizontal binary partitioning, vertical binary partitioning, horizontal ternary partitioning, and vertical ternary partitioning.

(51) In some implementations, video encoder **20** may further partition a coding block of a CU into

one or more $M \times N$ prediction blocks (PB). A prediction block is a rectangular (square or non-square) block of samples on which the same prediction, inter or intra, is applied. A prediction unit (PU) of a CU may comprise a prediction block of luma samples, two corresponding prediction blocks of chroma samples, and syntax elements used to predict the prediction blocks. In monochrome pictures or pictures having three separate color planes, a PU may comprise a single prediction block and syntax structures used to predict the prediction block. Video encoder **20** may generate predictive luma, Cb, and Cr blocks for luma, Cb, and Cr prediction blocks of each PU of the CU.

(52) Video encoder **20** may use intra prediction or inter prediction to generate the predictive blocks for a PU. If video encoder **20** uses intra prediction to generate the predictive blocks of a PU, video encoder **20** may generate the predictive blocks of the PU based on decoded samples of the frame associated with the PU. If video encoder **20** uses inter prediction to generate the predictive blocks of a PU, video encoder **20** may generate the predictive blocks of the PU based on decoded samples of one or more frames other than the frame associated with the PU.

(53) After video encoder **20** generates predictive luma, Cb, and Cr blocks for one or more PUs of a CU, video encoder **20** may generate a luma residual block for the CU by subtracting the CU's predictive luma blocks from its original luma coding block such that each sample in the CU's luma residual block indicates a difference between a luma sample in one of the CU's predictive luma blocks and a corresponding sample in the CU's original luma coding block. Similarly, video encoder **20** may generate a Cb residual block and a Cr residual block for the CU, respectively, such that each sample in the CU's Cb residual block indicates a difference between a Cb sample in one of the CU's predictive Cb blocks and a corresponding sample in the CU's original Cb coding block and each sample in the CU's Cr residual block may indicate a difference between a Cr sample in one of the CU's predictive Cr blocks and a corresponding sample in the CU's original Cr coding block.

(54) Furthermore, as illustrated in FIG. 4C, video encoder **20** may use quad-tree partitioning to decompose the luma, Cb, and Cr residual blocks of a CU into one or more luma, Cb, and Cr transform blocks. A transform block is a rectangular (square or non-square) block of samples on which the same transform is applied. A transform unit (TU) of a CU may comprise a transform block of luma samples, two corresponding transform blocks of chroma samples, and syntax elements used to transform the transform block samples. Thus, each TU of a CU may be associated with a luma transform block, a Cb transform block, and a Cr transform block. In some examples, the luma transform block associated with the TU may be a sub-block of the CU's luma residual block. The Cb transform block may be a sub-block of the CU's Cb residual block. The Cr transform block may be a sub-block of the CU's Cr residual block. In monochrome pictures or pictures having three separate color planes, a TU may comprise a single transform block and syntax structures used to transform the samples of the transform block.

(55) Video encoder **20** may apply one or more transforms to a luma transform block of a TU to generate a luma coefficient block for the TU. A coefficient block may be a two-dimensional array of transform coefficients. A transform coefficient may be a scalar quantity. Video encoder **20** may apply one or more transforms to a Cb transform block of a TU to generate a Cb coefficient block for the TU. Video encoder **20** may apply one or more transforms to a Cr transform block of a TU to generate a Cr coefficient block for the TU.

(56) After generating a coefficient block (e.g., a luma coefficient block, a Cb coefficient block or a Cr coefficient block), video encoder **20** may quantize the coefficient block. Quantization generally refers to a process in which transform coefficients are quantized to possibly reduce the amount of data used to represent the transform coefficients, providing further compression. After video encoder **20** quantizes a coefficient block, video encoder **20** may entropy encode syntax elements indicating the quantized transform coefficients. For example, video encoder **20** may perform Context-Adaptive Binary Arithmetic Coding (CABAC) on the syntax elements indicating the

quantized transform coefficients. Finally, video encoder **20** may output a bitstream that includes a sequence of bits that forms a representation of coded frames and associated data, which is either saved in storage device **32** or transmitted to destination device **14**.

(57) After receiving a bitstream generated by video encoder **20**, video decoder **30** may parse the bitstream to obtain syntax elements from the bitstream. Video decoder **30** may reconstruct the frames of the video data based at least in part on the syntax elements obtained from the bitstream. The process of reconstructing the video data is generally reciprocal to the encoding process performed by video encoder **20**. For example, video decoder **30** may perform inverse transforms on the coefficient blocks associated with TUs of a current CU to reconstruct residual blocks associated with the TUs of the current CU. Video decoder **30** also reconstructs the coding blocks of the current CU by adding the samples of the predictive blocks for PUs of the current CU to corresponding samples of the transform blocks of the TUs of the current CU. After reconstructing the coding blocks for each CU of a frame, video decoder **30** may reconstruct the frame.

(58) As noted above, video coding achieves video compression using primarily two modes, i.e., intra-frame prediction (or intra-prediction) and inter-frame prediction (or inter-prediction). Palette-based coding is another coding scheme that has been adopted by many video coding standards. In palette-based coding, which may be particularly suitable for screen-generated content coding, a video coder (e.g., video encoder **20** or video decoder **30**) forms a palette table of colors representing the video data of a given block. The palette table includes the most dominant (e.g., frequently used) pixel values in the given block. Pixel values that are not frequently represented in the video data of the given block are either not included in the palette table or included in the palette table as escape colors.

(59) Each entry in the palette table includes an index for a corresponding pixel value that in the palette table. The palette indices for samples in the block may be coded to indicate which entry from the palette table is to be used to predict or reconstruct which sample. This palette mode starts with the process of generating a palette predictor for a first block of a picture, slice, tile, or other such grouping of video blocks. As will be explained below, the palette predictor for subsequent video blocks is typically generated by updating a previously used palette predictor. For illustrative purpose, it is assumed that the palette predictor is defined at a picture level. In other words, a picture may include multiple coding blocks, each having its own palette table, but there is one palette predictor for the entire picture.

(60) To reduce the bits needed for signaling palette entries in the video bitstream, a video decoder may utilize a palette predictor for determining new palette entries in the palette table used for reconstructing a video block. For example, the palette predictor may include palette entries from a previously used palette table or even be initialized with a most recently used palette table by including all entries of the most recently used palette table. In some implementations, the palette predictor may include fewer than all the entries from the most recently used palette table and then incorporate some entries from other previously used palette tables. The palette predictor may have the same size as the palette tables used for coding different blocks or may be larger or smaller than the palette tables used for coding different blocks. In one example, the palette predictor is implemented as a first-in-first-out (FIFO) table including 64 palette entries.

(61) To generate a palette table for a block of video data from the palette predictor, a video decoder may receive, from the encoded video bitstream, a one-bit flag for each entry of the palette predictor. The one-bit flag may have a first value (e.g., a binary one) indicating that the associated entry of the palette predictor is to be included in the palette table or a second value (e.g., a binary zero) indicating that the associated entry of the palette predictor is not to be included in the palette table. If the size of palette predictor is larger than the palette table used for a block of video data, then the video decoder may stop receiving more flags once a maximum size for the palette table is reached.

(62) In some implementations, some entries in a palette table may be directly signaled in the

encoded video bitstream instead of being determined using the palette predictor. For such entries, the video decoder may receive, from the encoded video bitstream, three separate m-bit values indicating the pixel values for the luma and two chroma components associated with the entry, where m represents the bit depth of the video data. Compared with the multiple m-bit values needed for directly signaled palette entries, those palette entries derived from the palette predictor only require a one-bit flag. Therefore, signaling some or all palette entries using the palette predictor can significantly reduce the number of bits needed to signal the entries of a new palette table, thereby improving the overall coding efficiency of palette mode coding.

(63) In many instances, the palette predictor for one block is determined based on the palette table used to code one or more previously coded blocks. But when coding the first coding tree unit in a picture, a slice or a tile, the palette table of a previously coded block may not be available.

Therefore a palette predictor cannot be generated using entries of the previously used palette tables. In such case, a sequence of palette predictor initializers may be signaled in a sequence parameter set (SPS) and/or a picture parameter set (PPS), which are values used to generate a palette predictor when a previously used palette table is not available. An SPS generally refers to a syntax structure of syntax elements that apply to a series of consecutive coded video pictures called a coded video sequence (CVS) as determined by the content of a syntax element found in the PPS referred to by a syntax element found in each slice segment header. A PPS generally refers to a syntax structure of syntax elements that apply to one or more individual pictures within a CVS as determined by a syntax element found in each slice segment header. Thus, an SPS is generally considered to be a higher level syntax structure than a PPS, meaning the syntax elements included in the SPS generally change less frequently and apply to a larger portion of video data compared to the syntax elements included in the PPS.

(64) FIG. 5 is a block diagram illustrating different prediction modes of a coding unit in accordance with some implementations of the present disclosure.

(65) In VVC, each CU can be coded as skip mode or non-skip mode. For a CU coded as skip mode, one syntax element is further signaled to indicate whether the current CU is regular skip mode (similar to the skip mode in HEVC) or IBC skip mode. For a CU coded as non-skip mode, syntax elements are further signaled to indicate if the current CU is coded as intra mode, inter mode, intra block copy (IBC) mode or palette (PLT) mode. These modes are termed as “MODE_INTRA”, “MODE_INTER”, “MODE_IBC” and “MODE_PLT” respectively in the VVC specification. For a CU coded as intra mode, only the spatial neighboring reconstructed pixels in the same picture/slice could be used to generate the prediction signal for the current CU. For a CU coded as inter mode, the prediction signal can be generated by pixels from the reference pictures which are not the current picture. The detail of IBC mode could be found in document JVET-N1002 (at <http://phenix.int-evry.fr/jvet/>). The palette (PLT) mode is newly adopted into VVC in 15th JVET meeting with details explained in the document JVET-00119 located at <http://phenix.int-evry.fr/jvet/>.

(66) In the current VVC, the constraints and conditions for enabling each different mode are different, as summarized in Table 1 below. Moreover, a flag is signaled in sequence parameter set (SPS) to indicate the on/off of the IBC and PLT modes, i.e. indicating whether IBC and/or PLT mode are allowed in the associated bitstream.

(67) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 Constrains of enabling/signaling the non-skip related modes

Mode	Constraints
intra mode	no constraints
inter mode	(block width × block height) > 16
IBC mode	block width ≤ 64 && block height ≤ 64 && sps_ibc_enabled_flag && treeType != DUAL_TREE_CHROMA
PLT mode	block width ≤ 64 && block height ≤ 64 && sps_plt_enabled_flag

(68) The syntax of the mode signaling in current VVC is illustrated in the table below.

(69) TABLE-US-00002 TABLE 2 Syntax of prediction modes signaling in current VVC

Descriptor	coding_unit(x0, y0, cbWidth, cbHeight, cqtDepth, treeType, modeType)	{	chType = treeType =
------------	--	---	---------------------

```

= DUAL_TREE_CHROMA? 1 : 0    if( slice_type != I || sps_IBC_enabled_flag ||
sps_palette_enabled_flag ) {    if( treeType != DUAL_TREE_CHROMA &&      !(( (
cbWidth == 4 && cbHeight == 4 ) || modeType == MODE_TYPE_INTRA )      &&
!sps_IBC_enabled_flag ) )      cu_skip_flag[ x0 ][ y0 ] ae(v)      if( cu_skip_flag[ x0 ][ y0 ] =
= 0 && slice_type != I      && !( cbWidth == 4 && cbHeight == 4 ) && modeType ==
MODE_TYPE_ALL )      pred_mode_flag ae(v)      if( ( ( slice_type == I &&
cu_skip_flag[ x0 ][ y0 ] == 0 ) ||      ( slice_type != I && ( CuPredMode[ chType ][ x0
][ y0 ] != MODE_INTRA ||
cu_skip_flag[ x0 ][ y0 ] == 0 ) ) ) &&      cbWidth <= 64 && cbHeight <= 64 &&
modeType != MODE_TYPE_INTER &&      sps_IBC_enabled_flag && treeType !=
DUAL_TREE_CHROMA )      pred_mode_IBC_flag ae(v)      if( ( ( ( slice_type == I || (
cbWidth == 4 && cbHeight == 4 ) || sps_IBC_enabled_flag ) &&
CuPredMode[ x0 ][ y0 ] == MODE_INTRA ) ||      ( slice_type != I && !( cbWidth =
= 4 && cbHeight == 4 ) && !sps_IBC_enabled_flag      && CuPredMode[ x0 ][ y0 ]
!= MODE_INTRA ) ) && sps_palette_enabled_flag &&      cbWidth <= 64 &&
cbHeight <= 64 && && cu_skip_flag[ x0 ][ y0 ] == 0 &&      modeType !=
MODE_INTER )      pred_mode_plt_flag ae(v)    }

```

(70) The semantic of the mode signaling in current VVC is illustrated below.

(71) `cu_skip_flag[x0][y0]` equal to 1 specifies that for the current coding unit, when decoding a P or B slice, no more syntax elements except one or more of the following are parsed after `cu_skip_flag[x0][y0]`: the IBC mode flag `pred_mode_IBC_flag [x0][y0]`, and the `merge_data()` syntax structure; when decoding an I slice, no more syntax elements except `merge_idx[x0][y0]` are parsed after `cu_skip_flag[x0][y0]`. `cu_skip_flag[x0][y0]` equal to 0 specifies that the coding unit is not skipped. The array indices `x0`, `y0` specify the location (`x0`, `y0`) of the top-left luma sample of the considered coding block relative to the top-left luma sample of the picture. When `cu_skip_flag[x0][y0]` is not present, it is inferred to be equal to 0.

(72) `pred_mode_flag` equal to 0 specifies that the current coding unit is coded in inter prediction mode. `pred_mode_flag` equal to 1 specifies that the current coding unit is coded in intra prediction mode. When `pred_mode_flag` is not present, it is inferred as follows: If `cbWidth` is equal to 4 and `cbHeight` is equal to 4, `pred_mode_flag` is inferred to be equal to 1. Otherwise, if `modeType` is equal to `MODE_TYPE_INTRA`, `pred_mode_flag` is inferred to be equal to 1. Otherwise, if `modeType` is equal to `MODE_TYPE_INTER`, `pred_mode_flag` is inferred to be equal to 0. Otherwise, `pred_mode_flag` is inferred to be equal to 1 when decoding an I slice, and equal to 0 when decoding a P or B slice, respectively. The variable `CuPredMode[chType][x][y]` is derived as follows for `x=x0 . . . x0+cbWidth-1` and `y=y0 . . . y0+cbHeight-1`: If `pred_mode_flag` is equal to 0, `CuPredMode[chType][x][y]` is set equal to `MODE_INTER`. Otherwise (`pred_mode_flag` is equal to 1), `CuPredMode[chType][x][y]` is set equal to `MODE_INTRA`.

(73) `pred_mode_IBC_flag` equal to 1 specifies that the current coding unit is coded in IBC prediction mode. `pred_mode_IBC_flag` equal to 0 specifies that the current coding unit is not coded in IBC prediction mode. When `pred_mode_IBC_flag` is not present, it is inferred as follows: If `cu_skip_flag[x0][y0]` is equal to 1, and `cbWidth` is equal to 4, and `cbHeight` is equal to 4, `pred_mode_IBC_flag` is inferred to be equal 1. Otherwise, if both `cbWidth` and `cbHeight` are equal to 128, `pred_mode_IBC_flag` is inferred to be equal to 0. Otherwise, if `modeType` is equal to `MODE_TYPE_INTER`, `pred_mode_IBC_flag` is inferred to be equal to 0. Otherwise, if `treeType` is equal to `DUAL_TREE_CHROMA`, `pred_mode_IBC_flag` is inferred to be equal to 0. Otherwise, `pred_mode_IBC_flag` is inferred to be equal to the value of `sps_IBC_enabled_flag` when decoding an I slice, and 0 when decoding a P or B slice, respectively. When `pred_mode_IBC_flag` is equal to 1, the variable `CuPredMode[chType][x][y]` is set to be equal to `MODE_IBC` for `x=x0 . . . x0+cbWidth-1` and `y=y0 . . . y0+cbHeight-1`.

(74) `pred_mode_plt_flag` specifies the use of palette mode in the current coding unit.

pred_mode_plt_flag equal to 1 indicates that palette mode is applied in the current coding unit.
pred_mode_plt_flag equal to 0 indicates that palette mode is not applied in the current coding unit.
When pred_mode_plt_flag is not present, it is inferred to be equal to 0. When pred_mode_plt_flag is equal to 1, the variable CuPredMode[x][y] is set to be equal to MODE_PLT for $x=x_0 \dots x_0+cbWidth-1$ and $y=y_0 \dots y_0+cbHeight-1$.

(75) To summarize, in current VVC, the syntax (i.e. the associated flags) signaled to indicate the corresponding non-skip modes is shown in Table 4 to Table 10, with each table corresponding to different conditions of prediction modes allowed. It should be noted that in these tables the 0 and 1 in the codewords may all be inverted and the resulted codewords would function equally. Moreover, the naming of the syntax elements can also be changed to other names without changing the function of the signaled modes.

(76) TABLE-US-00003 TABLE 3 Signaling of the non-skip CU prediction modes in current VVC when all the modes (inter, inter, IBC and PLT modes) are allowed Pred_Modes pred_mode_flag pred_mode_ibc_flag pred_mode_plt_flag INTER 0 0 — IBC 0 1 — PLT 1 — 1 INTRA 1 — 0

(77) TABLE-US-00004 TABLE 4 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes in current VVC when only intra, IBC and PLT modes are allowed Pred_Modes pred_mode_flag pred_mode_ibc_flag pred_mode_plt_flag IBC — 1 — PLT — 0 1 INTRA — 0 0

(78) TABLE-US-00005 TABLE 5 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes in current VVC when only intra, inter and PLT modes are allowed Pred_Modes pred_mode_flag pred_mode_ibc_flag pred_mode_plt_flag INTER 0 — 0 PLT 0 — 1 INTRA 1 — —

(79) TABLE-US-00006 TABLE 6 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes in current VVC when only intra, inter and IBC modes are allowed Pred_Modes pred_mode_flag pred_mode_ibc_flag pred_mode_plt_flag INTER 0 0 — IBC 0 1 — INTRA 1 — —

(80) TABLE-US-00007 TABLE 7 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes in current VVC when only intra and IBC modes are allowed Pred_Modes pred_mode_flag pred_mode_ibc_flag pred_mode_plt_flag IBC — 1 — INTRA — 0 —

(81) TABLE-US-00008 TABLE 8 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes in current VVC when only intra and PLT modes are allowed Pred_Modes pred_mode_flag pred_mode_ibc_flag pred_mode_plt_flag PLT — — 1 INTRA — — 0

(82) TABLE-US-00009 TABLE 9 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes in current VVC when only intra and inter modes are allowed Pred_Modes pred_mode_flag pred_mode_ibc_flag pred_mode_plt_flag INTER 0 — — INTRA 1 — —

(83) FIG. 6 is a flowchart illustrating an exemplary process by which a video coder implements the techniques of signaling prediction mode in accordance with some implementations of the present disclosure.

(84) In current VVC, the IBC mode is regarded as a mode which is more similar to the inter mode while the PLT mode is regarded as a mode more similar to the intra mode. Therefore, in VVC, the IBC mode flag (pred_mode_ibc_flag) is signaled when the pred_mode_flag is signaled as 0 which implies the current CU is inter mode alike. The PLT mode flag (pred_mode_plt_flag) is signaled when the pred_mode_flag is signaled as 1 which implies the current CU is intra mode alike. However, there is one exception when only intra, inter and PLT modes are allowed (i.e. IBC mode is not allowed). As shown in Table 5, The PLT mode flag (pred_mode_plt_flag) is signaled when the pred_mode_flag is signaled as 0. Such an exception not only breaks the physical meaning of the flag of pred_mode_flag, it also complicates the signaling conditions of pred_mode_plt_flag because different signaling conditions are used depending on whether IBC mode is allowed or not.

(85) Moreover, in current VVC, the condition checking to signal the pred_mode_ibc_flag and pred_mode_plt_flag is complex as shown in Table 2. Several methods are proposed to simplify the condition checking in signaling these prediction modes.

(86) According to the first embodiment of the disclosure, the flag to indicate the enabling of the palette mode (e.g. pred_mode_plt_flag in VVC specification) is signaled only under intra-like

mode, regardless of the conditions of prediction modes allowed. In one example, only when the syntax element used to indicate the intra-like or inter-like mode (e.g. pred_mode_flag) is signaled or inferred as intra-like mode (e.g. signaling pred_mode_flag as 1 in current VVC), the palette mode flag pred_mode_plt_flag is signaled. According to the embodiment, when only inter, intra and PLT modes are allowed, the corresponding codewords are illustrated in Table 10. It is different from Table 5. Moreover, the signaling conditions of pred_mode_plt_flag can be simplified as highlighted in Table 11.

(87) TABLE-US-00010 TABLE 10 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when only intra, inter and PLT modes are allowed based on the first embodiment Pred_Modes pred_mode_flag
pred_mode_ibc_flag pred_mode_plt_flag INTER 0 — — PLT 1 — 1 INTRA 1 — 0

(88) TABLE-US-00011 TABLE 11 Syntax of proposed mode signaling for VVC (the modified parts are highlighted) Descriptor coding_unit(x0, y0, cbWidth, cbHeight, cqtDepth, treeType, modeType) {
 chType = treeType == DUAL_TREE_CHROMA? 1 : 0 if(slice_type != I ||
 sps_ibc_enabled_flag || sps_palette_enabled_flag) { if(treeType != DUAL_TREE_CHROMA
&& !(((cbWidth == 4 && cbHeight == 4) || modeType == MODE_TYPE_INTRA)
 && !sps_ibc_enabled_flag)) cu_skip_flag[x0][y0] ae(v) if(
cu_skip_flag[x0][y0] == 0 && slice_type != I && !(cbWidth == 4 && cbHeight == 4
) && modeType == MODE_TYPE_ALL) pred_mode_flag ae(v) if(((slice_type
== I && cu_skip_flag[x0][y0] == 0) || (slice_type != I && (CuPredMode[
chType][x0][y0] != MODE_INTRA || (cbWidth == 4 && cbHeight == 4
&& cu_skip_flag[x0][y0] == 0))) && cbWidth <= 64 && cbHeight <= 64 &&
modeType != MODE_TYPE_INTER && sps_ibc_enabled_flag && treeType !=
DUAL_TREE_CHROMA) pred_mode_ibc_flag ae(v) if((CuPredMode[x0][y0] =
= MODE_INTRA) && sps_palette_enabled_flag && cbWidth <= 64 && cbHeight
<= 64 && && cu_skip_flag[x0][y0] == 0 && modeType != MODE_INTER)
 pred_mode_plt_flag ae(v) } (...the rest of the spec for the coding unit) }

(89) According to the second embodiment of the disclosure, the modes are signaled based on a predefined order, with each mode indicated through a corresponding flag except the very last mode. The very last mode does not need a corresponding flag because it can be inferred as enabled when all the previously signaled modes (or flags) are not enabled. In one example, inter mode, IBC mode and PLT mode are respectively indicated through a flag pred_mode_inter_flag, pred_mode_ibc_flag and pred_mode_plt_flag. In this case, the method is basically identical to assigning the truncated binary codewords to the modes based on a predefined order of signaling. The associated codewords are illustrated in Table 12 to Table 18. The signaling conditions of pred_mode_ibc_flag and pred_mode_plt_flag can also be simplified, as highlighted in Table 19.

(90) TABLE-US-00012 TABLE 12 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when all the modes (inter, inter, IBC and PLT modes) are allowed, based on the second embodiment Pred_ pred_mode_ pred_mode_ pred_mode_ Modes inter_flag ibc_flag plt_flag INTER 1 — — IBC 0 1 — PLT 0 0 1 INTRA 0 0 0

(91) TABLE-US-00013 TABLE 13 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when only intra, IBC and PLT modes are allowed, based on the second embodiment Pred_ pred_mode_ pred_mode_ pred_mode_ Modes inter_flag ibc_flag plt_flag IBC — 1 — PLT — 0 1 INTRA — 0 0

(92) TABLE-US-00014 TABLE 14 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when only intra, inter and PLT modes are allowed, based on the second embodiment Pred_ pred_mode_ pred_mode_ pred_mode_ Modes inter_flag ibc_flag plt_flag INTER 1 — — PLT 0 — 1 INTRA 0 — 0

(93) TABLE-US-00015 TABLE 15 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when only intra, inter and IBC modes are allowed, based on the second embodiment Pred_ pred_mode_ pred_mode_ pred_mode_ Modes inter_flag ibc_flag plt_flag INTER 1 — — IBC 0 1 — INTRA 0 0 —

(94) TABLE-US-00016 TABLE 16 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when only intra and IBC modes are allowed, based on the second embodiment Pred_ pred_mode_ pred_mode_ pred_mode_ Modes inter_flag ibc_flag plt_flag INTER 1 — — IBC 0 1 — INTRA 0 0 —

Modes inter_flag ibc_flag plt_flag IBC — 1 — INTRA — 0 —

(95) TABLE-US-00017 TABLE 17 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when only intra and PLT modes are allowed, based on the second embodiment Pred_pred_mode_pred_mode_pred_mode_Modes inter_flag ibc_flag plt_flag PLT — — 1 INTRA — — 0

(96) TABLE-US-00018 TABLE 18 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when only intra and inter modes are allowed, based on the second embodiment Pred_pred_mode_pred_mode_pred_mode_Modes inter_flag ibc_flag plt_flag INTER 1 — — INTRA 0 — —

(97) TABLE-US-00019 TABLE 19 Syntax of proposed mode signaling for VVC (the modified parts are highlighted) Descriptor coding_unit(x0, y0, cbWidth, cbHeight, cqtDepth, treeType, modeType) {
 chType = treeType == DUAL_TREE_CHROMA? 1 : 0 if(slice_type != I ||
 sps_ibc_enabled_flag || sps_palette_enabled_flag) { if(treeType != DUAL_TREE_CHROMA
 && !(((cbWidth == 4 && cbHeight == 4) || modeType == MODE_TYPE_INTRA)
 && !sps_ibc_enabled_flag)) cu_skip_flag[x0][y0] ae(v) if(
 cu_skip_flag[x0][y0] == 0 && slice_type != I && !(cbWidth == 4 && cbHeight == 4
) && modeType == MODE_TYPE_ALL) pred_mode_inter_flag ae(v) if(((
 slice_type == I && cu_skip_flag[x0][y0] == 0) || (slice_type != I &&
 CuPredMode[x0][y0] == MODE_INTRA)) && cbWidth <= 64 && cbHeight <=
 64 && modeType != MODE_TYPE_INTER && sps_ibc_enabled_flag && treeType
 != DUAL_TREE_CHROMA) pred_mode_ibc_flag ae(v) if((CuPredMode[x0][
 y0] == MODE_INTRA) && sps_palette_enabled_flag && cbWidth <= 64 &&
 cbHeight <= 64 && && cu_skip_flag[x0][y0] == 0 && modeType !=
 MODE_INTER) pred_mode_plt_flag ae(v) }

(98) According to the third embodiment of the disclosure, the modes are signaled by first sending a syntax element to indicate whether the regular modes (such as inter and intra modes) or the new modes (such as the IBC and PLT modes) are used by the current block. After the first syntax element, additional syntax elements are signaled to indicate which mode is used. The associated codewords are illustrated in Table 20 to Table 26. It is noted that naming of the codeword bins (or flags) is changed to reflect their physical meaning according to this embodiment.

(99) TABLE-US-00020 TABLE 20 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when all the modes (inter, inter, IBC and PLT modes) are allowed, based on the third embodiment pred_mode_pred_mode_pred_mode_Pred_Modes regular_flag inter_flag ibc_flag INTER 1 1 — IBC 0 — 1 PLT 0 — 0 INTRA 1 0 —

(100) TABLE-US-00021 TABLE 21 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when only intra, IBC and PLT modes are allowed, based on the third embodiment pred_mode_pred_mode_pred_mode_Pred_Modes regular_flag inter_flag ibc_flag IBC 0 — 1 PLT 0 — 0 INTRA 1 — —

(101) TABLE-US-00022 TABLE 22 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when only intra, inter and PLT modes are allowed, based on the third embodiment pred_mode_pred_mode_pred_mode_Pred_Modes regular_flag inter_flag ibc_flag INTER 1 1 — PLT 0 — — INTRA 1 0 —

(102) TABLE-US-00023 TABLE 23 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when only intra, inter and IBC modes are allowed, based on the third embodiment pred_mode_pred_mode_pred_mode_Pred_Modes regular_flag inter_flag ibc_flag INTER 1 1 — IBC 0 — — INTRA 1 0 —

(103) TABLE-US-00024 TABLE 24 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when only intra and IBC modes are allowed, based on the third embodiment pred_mode_pred_mode_pred_mode_Pred_Modes regular_flag inter_flag ibc_flag IBC 0 — — INTRA 1 — —

(104) TABLE-US-00025 TABLE 25 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when only intra and PLT modes are allowed, based on the third embodiment pred_mode_pred_mode_pred_mode_Pred_Modes regular_flag inter_flag ibc_flag PLT 0 — — INTRA 1 — —

(105) TABLE-US-00026 TABLE 26 Signaling of the non-skip CU modes when only intra and inter modes are allowed, based on the third embodiment pred_mode_pred_mode_pred_mode_Pred_Modes regular_flag inter_flag ibc_flag INTER — 1 — INTRA — 0 —

(106) To signal a prediction mode, the video coder first receives, from bitstream, video data corresponding to a non-skip mode coded block (610) and determines a parameter set associated with the non-skip mode coded block (620). The parameter set (e.g., a sequence parameter set) includes information to include which mode (e.g., IBC, PLT, etc) is allowed in the associated bitstream, as indicated by Table 1.

(107) Next, the video coder selectively receives a first, second, or third syntax elements from the bitstream. If the parameter set includes information that satisfies a first condition, the video coder retrieves a first syntax element (e.g., pre_mode_flag in Table 2) from the bitstream (630). If the parameter set includes information that satisfies a second condition, the video coder retrieves a second syntax element (e.g., pre_mode_ibc_flag in Table 2) from the bitstream (640). If the parameter set includes information that satisfies a third condition, the video coder retrieves a third syntax element (e.g., pre_mode_plt_flag in Table 2) from the bitstream (650). For the conditions associated with each of the respective syntax elements, refer to Table 2. In some embodiments, if a respective condition is not satisfied, the video coder does not receive the respective syntax element (e.g., the video coder may assign default values to the syntax elements or do not use the syntax elements during decoding).

(108) Next, the video coder decodes the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using a respective mode, depending on the values of the received first, second, and third syntax elements. In particular:

(109) The video coder decodes the video data using palette mode when both the first syntax element (e.g., pred_mode_flag in Table 1) and the third syntax element (e.g., pre_mode_plt_flag in Table 1) have a first value (e.g., “1”), and the second condition is not satisfied (e.g., the video coder does not receive pre_mode_ibc_flag) (660).

(110) The video coder decodes the video data using intra prediction mode when the first syntax element (e.g., pred_mode_flag in Table 1) has the first value (e.g., “1”) and the third syntax element has a second value (e.g., “0”). The second condition is not satisfied (e.g., the video coder does not receive pred_mode_ibc_flag) (670).

(111) The video coder decodes the video data using inter prediction mode when the first syntax element has the second value (e.g., “0”) and the second and the third conditions are not satisfied (e.g., the video coder does not receive pred_mode_ibc_flag and pre_mode_plt_flag) (680).

(112) In one or more examples, the functions described may be implemented in hardware, software, firmware, or any combination thereof. If implemented in software, the functions may be stored on or transmitted over, as one or more instructions or code, a computer-readable medium and executed by a hardware-based processing unit. Computer-readable media may include computer-readable storage media, which corresponds to a tangible medium such as data storage media, or communication media including any medium that facilitates transfer of a computer program from one place to another, e.g., according to a communication protocol. In this manner, computer-readable media generally may correspond to (1) tangible computer-readable storage media which is non-transitory or (2) a communication medium such as a signal or carrier wave. Data storage media may be any available media that can be accessed by one or more computers or one or more processors to retrieve instructions, code and/or data structures for implementation of the implementations described in the present application. A computer program product may include a computer-readable medium.

(113) The terminology used in the description of the implementations herein is for the purpose of describing particular implementations only and is not intended to limit the scope of claims. As used in the description of the implementations and the appended claims, the singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” are intended to include the plural forms as well, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. It will also be understood that the term “and/or” as used herein refers to and encompasses any and all possible combinations of one or more of the associated listed items. It will be further understood that the terms “comprises” and/or “comprising,” when used in this

specification, specify the presence of stated features, elements, and/or components, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, elements, components, and/or groups thereof.

(114) It will also be understood that, although the terms first, second, etc. may be used herein to describe various elements, these elements should not be limited by these terms. These terms are only used to distinguish one element from another. For example, a first electrode could be termed a second electrode, and, similarly, a second electrode could be termed a first electrode, without departing from the scope of the implementations. The first electrode and the second electrode are both electrodes, but they are not the same electrode.

(115) The description of the present application has been presented for purposes of illustration and description, and is not intended to be exhaustive or limited to the invention in the form disclosed. Many modifications, variations, and alternative implementations will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art having the benefit of the teachings presented in the foregoing descriptions and the associated drawings. The embodiment was chosen and described in order to best explain the principles of the invention, the practical application, and to enable others skilled in the art to understand the invention for various implementations and to best utilize the underlying principles and various implementations with various modifications as are suited to the particular use contemplated. Therefore, it is to be understood that the scope of claims is not to be limited to the specific examples of the implementations disclosed and that modifications and other implementations are intended to be included within the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A method of encoding video data, the method comprising: obtaining a parameter set associated with a non-skip mode coded block; in accordance with a determination that the parameter set includes information that satisfies a first condition, signaling a first syntax element in a bitstream; in accordance with a determination that the parameter set includes information that satisfies a second condition, signaling a second syntax element in the bitstream; in accordance with a determination that the parameter set includes information that satisfies a third condition, signaling a third syntax element in the bitstream; encoding video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using palette mode when the first syntax element has a first value and the third syntax element has the first value; encoding the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using intra prediction mode when the first syntax element has the first value and the third syntax element has a second value; encoding the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using inter prediction mode when the first syntax element has the second value; and transmitting the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block via the bitstream.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein when the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block is encoded using the palette mode, the second condition is not satisfied and the second syntax element is not signaled.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein when the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block is encoded using the intra prediction mode, the second condition is not satisfied and the second syntax element is not signaled.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein when the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block is encoded using the inter prediction mode, the second and the third conditions are not satisfied and the second and the third syntax elements are not signaled.
5. The method of claim 1, further comprising: encoding the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using intra block copy mode when the first syntax element has a second value or the first syntax element is not signaled, the second syntax element has the first value, and the third syntax element is not signaled.
6. A computing device comprising: one or more processors; memory coupled to the one or more

processors; and a plurality of programs stored in the memory that, when executed by the one or more processors, cause the computing device to perform operations comprising: obtaining a parameter set associated with a non-skip mode coded block; in accordance with a determination that the parameter set includes information that satisfies a first condition, signaling a first syntax element in a bitstream; in accordance with a determination that the parameter set includes information that satisfies a second condition, signaling a second syntax element in the bitstream; in accordance with a determination that the parameter set includes information that satisfies a third condition, signaling a third syntax element in the bitstream; encoding video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using palette mode when the first syntax element has a first value and the third syntax element has the first value; encoding the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using intra prediction mode when the first syntax element has the first value and the third syntax element has a second value; encoding the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using inter prediction mode when the first syntax element has the second value; and transmitting the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block via the bitstream.

7. The device of claim 6, wherein when the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block is encoded using the palette mode, the second condition is not satisfied and the second syntax element is not signaled.

8. The device of claim 6, wherein when the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block is encoded using the intra prediction mode, the second condition is not satisfied and the second syntax element is not signaled.

9. The device of claim 6, wherein when the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block is encoded using the inter prediction mode, the second and the third conditions are not satisfied and the second and the third syntax elements are not signaled.

10. The device of claim 6, the operations further comprising: encoding the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using intra block copy mode when the first syntax element has a second value or the first syntax element is not signaled, the second syntax element has the first value, and the third syntax element is not signaled.

11. A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium storing a bitstream generated by an encoding apparatus when performing operations comprising: obtaining a parameter set associated with a non-skip mode coded block; in accordance with a determination that the parameter set includes information that satisfies a first condition, signaling a first syntax element in the bitstream; in accordance with a determination that the parameter set includes information that satisfies a second condition, signaling a second syntax element in the bitstream; in accordance with a determination that the parameter set includes information that satisfies a third condition, signaling a third syntax element in the bitstream; encoding video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using palette mode when the first syntax element has a first value and the third syntax element has the first value; encoding the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using intra prediction mode when the first syntax element has the first value and the third syntax element has a second value; encoding the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using inter prediction mode when the first syntax element has the second value; and transmitting the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block via the bitstream.

12. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein when the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block is encoded using the palette mode, the second condition is not satisfied and the second syntax element is not signaled.

13. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein when the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block is encoded using the intra prediction mode, the second condition is not satisfied and the second syntax element is not signaled.

14. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein when the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block is encoded using the inter prediction mode,

the second and the third conditions are not satisfied and the second and the third syntax elements are not signaled.

15. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein the operations further comprise: encoding the video data corresponding to the non-skip mode coded block using intra block copy mode when the first syntax element has a second value or the first syntax element is not signaled, the second syntax element has the first value, and the third syntax element is not signaled.
